

RAM, storage, display, battery and weight

General guidance for shoppers in India. Not specific to any one product; always check the exact configuration and current price before buying.

RAM (memory)

8 GB is the bare minimum today and is fine for browsing, documents and video calls. 16 GB is the sensible target for programming, many browser tabs, light video editing and any laptop you want to keep for several years. 32 GB is for heavy editing, virtual machines, large datasets and professional creative work. Check whether the RAM is soldered to the board or upgradeable: many thin laptops and all MacBooks have fixed RAM, so you must buy the amount you need up front.

Storage

Choose an NVMe SSD, which is far faster than an old hard disk. 256 GB fills up quickly; 512 GB is a comfortable baseline; 1 TB suits gamers (modern games are large), video editors and people who keep many files locally. Some laptops have a free slot for a second SSD, which is a cheap way to add space later.

Display

Full HD (1920 x 1080) is fine for most people. Higher resolutions such as 2.8K or QHD look sharper and are nicer for reading and creative work but use more battery. IPS panels are the common good-quality choice with wide viewing angles. OLED panels give deep blacks and vivid colour and are excellent for media and creative work, but they can be costlier and use more power with bright content. Brightness around 300 nits is acceptable indoors, and 400 nits or more is better in bright rooms. Creators should look for strong colour coverage such as full sRGB or DCI-P3. Gamers should look for a higher refresh rate such as 120, 144 or 165 Hz, which makes motion look smoother than the standard 60 Hz.

Battery

Battery capacity is measured in watt-hours (Wh). Around 40 to 50 Wh is typical for budget laptops, 55 to 75 Wh is good, and larger batteries appear in big gaming and creator laptops. Real battery life depends on the processor, the screen and your use, so a bigger number does not always mean longer life. Gaming laptops last only a few hours away from the charger, and gaming performance is best when plugged in.

Weight and size

Under about 1.4 kg is easy to carry every day. Around 1.5 to 1.8 kg is fine for a bag you carry occasionally. Gaming laptops often weigh 2.2 kg or more plus a heavy charger. A 14-inch screen is the best balance for portability, 15.6 inches is the common all-round size, and 16 inches or more suits desk-based work and gaming.